

GAURAV JOSHI

Enterprise Transformation Consultant | Process Re-engineering | Strategy Execution | Regulated Enterprise

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Transformation consultant, 18+ years connecting strategy to ground-level execution across travel e-commerce, loyalty redemption, media & entertainment, banking procurement and regulated enterprise platforms, delivered in India, South Africa and the UK. Seven years in Nihilent's Enterprise Transformation Group, then eleven inside product organisations. Worked extensively to bridge the gap between strategy formation and execution.

WHAT I AM KNOWN FOR

- **Crossing the gap where most business cases die:** the same person who built the cost-benefit model at Standard Bank also piloted the contact centre, live, in 3 months - later rolled out nationally.
- **Securing adoption without a reporting line:** worked on regulatory compliance at JPMorgan Chase across 15+ product teams and 40 stakeholders.
- **Strategy translated into instrumentation, not slideware:** objectives converted into KPIs, data elements and calculation logic on a live operational system at Banking Association South Africa.
- **Adoption designed for sceptics:** competency assessment, training-needs analysis and change sessions built for stakeholders who started as detractors.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vice President, Product Management - Travel & Cross-Product Strategy | JPMorgan Chase & Co. | Feb 2020 - Sep 2026

- Led enterprise dark-pattern regulatory compliance (FTC, CA, TX, MA; equivalent to India CPA 2019 and DPDP Act 2023) across 15+ product teams and 40 stakeholders with no direct authority - built the governance model, translated regulation into product-level decisions, 100% compliant within mandated timelines.
- Proposed a redesigned enterprise client onboarding operating model: end-to-end process mapping, waste elimination, automation identification and cross-functional RACI, with the proposed model estimated to reduce onboarding from 6-8 months to ~3 months including client UAT.
- Inherited a stalled supplier-error workstream (FIFT) and drove it to outcome: support alerts down 50% and booking failures down 30% across 9 suppliers, with 38 standardised error categories. Set the sequencing basis (alert volume against booking impact) and held the resolution cadence with API and connector teams; ground-level taxonomy analysis was owned by a product analyst on the workstream.
- Led an on-premises-to-cloud migration for a travel and loyalty platform processing ~\$25M in monthly GTV, enabling a complete corporate data centre exit. Achieved 100% client adoption with zero downtime across 3 distinct launches for 5 enterprise clients within 12 months; the platform supported flights, hotels, car rentals, and activities. Managed 4 product managers, each owning an independent partner workstream with dotted-line authority over their engineering and architecture teams (a 27-person cross-functional team spanning product, engineering, data and UX.)
- Shipped a new UI and zero-to-one features like guest flow and new forms of payment toggle during migration.
- Discovery PoC delivered: analysed detractor voice-of-customer data, supplier content and regulatory verbiage to surface 3 causal loops driving compliance risk and NPS damage; converted them into two validated solutions - a readability redesign of lodging policy and cancellation content, and automated scanning of supplier content against regulatory sources to flag risky terms and trigger action. Both went to the owning teams; the scanning concept is on the AI team's backlog.
- Operated on capacity allocation, effort estimation and structured approval per initiative rather than a pre-allocated annual budget pool.

Solution Architect | Cybage Software Pvt. Ltd. | May 2015 - Feb 2020

- Owned business-led definition of foundational enterprise platform components, role-based access control and a configurable rules engine; so decisions on ambiguous, continuously shifting architecture stayed business-driven rather than technology-driven.
- Managed 3 senior business analysts on independent module workstreams with consolidated roadmap accountability; mentored 5 junior analysts through BABOK-anchored training content built in-house.
- Delivered a major overhaul to an enterprise leave management product within 18 months, introducing a decision-table method for complex business rules that other product teams adopted as practice.

Enterprise Transformation Consultant | Nihilent Technologies Pvt. Ltd. | Feb 2008 - May 2015

Strategy execution, process re-engineering and system re-engineering for banking procurement, media and non-profit clients, delivered onsite in South Africa and the UK. Led 4-5 consultants and business analysts across assignments.

- Banking Association South Africa: implemented an integrated performance management system using Nihilent's LAMAT strategy-execution platform. Strategy maps at organisational and divisional level, balanced scorecards at all three levels, translating objectives into KPIs, data elements and calculation logic, with targets cascading top-down and actuals rolling up bottom-up on a live system.
- Designed and ran the competency assessment programme (CAS) at the same client. Self, manager and joint assessments, then analysed findings to identify training needs and capability gaps at individual, divisional and organisational level. Secured adoption from experienced and openly sceptical stakeholders through structured education and formats that made abstract concepts tangible.

- Standard Bank South Africa: mapped the as-is procurement process, designed the to-be model, quantified the opportunity in a cost-benefit business case, then delivered the PoC operationally in 3 months with telephony, call scripts, SAP access and system changes, staff training and success metrics across 5 live branches without disrupting their operations, as a contractor with no formal authority. Rolled out nationally as Project Prologue later; CIPS Southern Africa Best Process Improvement Initiative 2010.
- SuperSport and M-Net: onsite lead re-engineering a legacy on-premise contracts, media and scheduling platform. 7 consecutive releases over 2.5 years, 2 analysts reporting in, offshore team of 30-40. Built a new reporting and analysis module within legacy tooling constraints when the client declined BI investment.
- Customer loyalty evaluation product: took a CEO's 8-page concept to commercial launch in 12 months as a two-person team, with full go-to-market, running primary research on a near-zero budget and building an analysis framework that became a standard product feature.
- Also: short client assignments - Medscheme, South Africa (Proxy Product Owner, healthcare core system upgrade, 3 business analysts reporting in, 2014-15) and Havas Media UK (onsite analysis, 2014).

CORE SKILLS

Transformation: Business Process Re-engineering | Operating Model Design | As-Is / To-Be Process Mapping | Strategy Execution | Strategy Maps & Balanced Scorecards | Competency Assessment | Waste Elimination | RACI Design

Business Case & Analysis: Business Case Development | Cost-Benefit Analysis | ROI Modelling | Proof of Concept Design & Delivery | Requirements Elicitation | BRD / FRD / Use Cases | Decision Tables | Gap Analysis

Change & Stakeholders: Change Management | Training & Enablement | Capability Building & Behavioural Training | Stakeholder Management at CXO, Legal, Risk and Operations Level | Influence Without Authority | Client Relationship Management | Team & Consultant Leadership

Domain: Banking Procurement & Supply Chain | Media & Entertainment | e-commerce | Travel & Loyalty | Regulatory Compliance | HRMS & Enterprise Platforms

Tools: MS Visio | Jira | Jira Align | Confluence | Balsamiq | Grafana | Kibana | SAS | TFS

CONSULTING & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- **Creator of Swanubhava™, a product management behavioural model:** trains the behaviour behind the work and measures it by the decisions people make. 8 observable behaviours inspired by the ICF Core Competencies, built to develop recognition-primed decision-making (RPD); Claude skills generate training scenarios to the requirement. It grew out of a weekly case-solving forum I have run across three organisations.
- Speaker, IPA Summit - 'The Sherlock Way': simplifying complex business processes for automation. Delivered strategy execution sessions as an alumnus of Indira School of Business Studies. Contributor, IIBA Product Ownership Analysis Guide.
- Tata Safari AI Assistant (live, 2026): built and deployed solo - ask in plain language or upload a photo of a dashboard warning light, and get answers grounded only in the official manuals. Multimodal RAG on Google Gemini with vector search, deployed on Streamlit Cloud. safari-ai-assistant-gsj24983.streamlit.app | github.com/GSJ24983/safari-ai-assistant
- OWL, portfolio assistant (live, 2026): built solo with Claude as engineering partner. Answers visitor questions only from my portfolio: each fact is checked against the content and every answer is cross-checked by a second model (Gemini generates, Claude evaluates). It does not invent answers; if a check fails, it declines. Tested on a 120+ question suite including trick and prompt-injection questions, and audited with my own AI Trustworthiness Matrix. gsj24983.github.io

CERTIFICATIONS & ONGOING TRAINING

- Designing and Building AI Products and Services - Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT xPRO). In progress, 2026.
- SAFe Product Owner / Product Manager (POPM) - Scaled Agile | Certified Scrum Product Owner (CSPO) - Scrum Alliance | Certified Business Analysis Professional (CBAP) - IIBA

EDUCATION

P.G.D.B.M. Marketing | Indira School of Business Studies, Pune | 2006-08

B.E. Instrumentation Engineering | D. Y. Patil College of Engineering, Pune | 2001-05

AWARDS, PUBLICATIONS & RECOGNITION

- Winner, CIPS Southern Africa Best Process Improvement Initiative 2010 (Standard Bank South Africa). Outstanding Alumni Award. Nihilent Best Team Award.
- Contributor, IIBA Product Ownership Analysis Guide. Author, white paper: Smart Content Scheduling using the Analytic Hierarchy Process (AHP). Speaker, IPA Summit ('The Sherlock Way'). Featured case study, University of the Witwatersrand (WITS). 28 long-form articles published on LinkedIn.
- Two Exemplary Assignment awards during Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT xPRO) certification: AI-enabled organisational strategy, and a responsible-AI feasibility assessment of a generative solution.